THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 7 — SOCIAL_SCIENCE · MEDIUM LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 2

Chapters 5–8: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why must a historian be cautious in using a prashasti? 1

(a) it praises the king and may exaggerate **(b)** it is always true
(c) it is unwritten **(d)** it is modern

2. What does the varna-jati system reflect? 1

(a) no divisions
(b) one occupation
(c) division of society by occupation and birth
(d) equality

3. The Mauryan spies were used to 1

(a) fight wars **(b)** farm
(c) trade **(d)** gather information about the empire

4. Gandhara art shows Greek influence in 1

(a) caves **(b)** realistic, wavy-haired Buddha figures
(c) stupas only **(d)** red sandstone

5. Varahamihira's Brihat Samhita covers 1

(a) astronomy, weather, plants and architecture
(b) only law
(c) only war
(d) only poetry

6. Why did guilds matter? 1

(a) they printed coins **(b)** they made laws
(c) they organised crafts and trade **(d)** they ruled states

7. A modern historian relies on both edicts and Indica because 1

(a) one is enough
(b) cross-checking sources gives a fuller picture
(c) both agree always
(d) both are modern

8. What is the importance of Udayagiri-Khandagiri caves? 1

(a) markets
(b) forts
(c) Jain monks' cells and Kharavela's inscription
(d) tombs

9. What does the cave temple at Udayagiri show? 1

(a) royal patronage of rock-cut art **(b)** no art
(c) war **(d)** trade

10. Why did trade grow along with coins? 1

(a) standard money made exchange easier **(b)** coins were free
(c) barter ended trade **(d)** coins were rare

11. Why was Chandragupta able to defeat the Nanda ruler? 1

(a) support of Kautilya and a strong army **(b)** Nanda's strength
(c) lack of army **(d)** foreign help only

12. Why do Satavahana coins show ships? 1

(a) ships were gods **(b)** sea trade was important
(c) ships were weapons **(d)** no sea

13. The Iron Pillar proves that Gupta metallurgists 1

(a) knew nothing **(b)** used gold only
(c) had advanced knowledge of iron **(d)** used no metal

14. Why did occupations become hereditary over time? 1

(a) skills passed through families **(b)** by law only
(c) by elections **(d)** by chance

15. Mauryan provinces were governed by 1

(a) foreign kings **(b)** the Senate
(c) princes and officials **(d)** tribal councils

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. What is the role of dhamma mahamattas? 2

17. Why is the Kallanai notable? 2

18. Why is the Iron Pillar a marvel? 2

19. What is the importance of archaeology? 2

20. What was the importance of guilds? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Explain the role of women in the Gupta age. 3

22. Describe the capitals of the mahajanapadas. 3

23. Explain how the capital Pataliputra was run. 3

24. Explain why many kingdoms rose after the Mauryas. 3

OR

Describe the metallurgy of the Gupta era. 3

25. Explain how coins differed from barter. 3

OR

Explain the main ideas of the Arthashastra. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Explain the sources that help us study the cities of the period. 5

OR

Describe the decline of the Maurya Empire. 5

27. Explain the role of inscriptions and coins in reconstructing this period. 5

OR

Discuss the role of regional kingdoms during the Gupta age. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND